



Bluetooth's be gone

NTT Docomo has introduced headset for smartphones that sits in front of your eyes

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Facebook now allows users to download a copy of their profile into a .zip file

CELLPHONES



Apple iPhone 3GS 32 GB
Price: ₹41,500



Sony Ericsson Xperia X10 Mini Pro
Price: ₹16,000 (MRP)



Nokia E72
Price: ₹16,000 (MRP)



Nokia N8
Price: ₹26,259



SPECIFICATIONS

Display: 3.5-inch, 16-million, 480x320 pixels; CPU: ARM Cortex A8 (600 MHz); RAM: 256 MB; Camera: 3-megapixel (VGA video recording); Weight: 135 g; Dimensions : 115.5 x 62.1 x 12.3 mm

OS: Android 1.6; CPU: Qualcomm MSM7227 600 MHz; RAM: 128 MB; Camera : 5-megapixel; Battery: 930 mAh; Display: 2.55-inches (240 x 320 pixels); Weight: 120 g; Dimensions : 90 x 52 x 17 mm

Display: 2.4-inch, 16-million, 240x320 pixels; CPU: 600 MHz ARM 11; RAM: 128 MB; ROM: 250 MB; Expansion: microSD; Camera: 5-megapixel; Battery: 1500 mAh; Weight: 128 g; Dimensions : 114 x 58 x 10 mm

OS: Symbian ^3; CPU: ARM 11 680 MHz; RAM : 256 MB; ROM : 512 MB; Display: 3.5-inch (360x640 pixels), 16 million colours; Battery: 1200 mAh; Weight: 135 g; Dimensions : 113.5 x 59.1 x 12.9 mm

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All Scores out of 10)

Features.....8.0
One of the best touch interfaces. The list of features is wide, as is application support.

Performance8.0
Audio and video playback rocks. As a phone, performance is decent, but not at par with phones from Nokia and BlackBerry. The capacitive-touch keypad is still one of the best around.

Build quality8.5
Sturdy all-metal construction. Only the display is delicate, and you might not want to drop it.

Value for money.....5.5
₹41,500 is a lot to pay. Decent value for around ₹30,000.

Features.....8.0
Compact with a good feature set, a QWERTY keypad that is actually quite usable.

Performance.....8.0
This phone is a good performer – music quality, the camera, call clarity, its zippy, and best of all, battery life is pretty decent. Overall we were quite satisfied.

Build quality.....7.0
Pretty solidly built and we liked the slider mechanism – slick and robust. Compact factor adds to the solid feel.

Value for money.....7.0
Great value for money for QWERTY, Android 2.1 and good performer.

Features.....8.0
The E72 is a loaded device: good camera, great battery, great QWERTY keypad.

Performance8.0
Sublime battery life is pretty unmatched as is the superb music quality. Call clarity is very good, better than other most non-Nokia phones, but not the best around.

Build quality7.0
Solid steel battery cover, thick plastic used all around, the E72 is slim too and that adds rigidity. Keypad is built well.

Value for money.....7.0
If you don't want a touch-based device, then the E72 is superb value for money.

Features.....8.0
The camera dominates proceedings with a lot of settings. Symbian^3 on a capacitive display is also good.

Performance7.5
The N8 performs well as a multimedia device. It's also pretty snappy, and we liked the performance of the on-screen keypad. Call clarity was very good.

Build quality8.0
The casing is almost entirely aluminium and also has extremely strong Gorilla glass

Value for money.....7.0
Little expensive, but for the features we feel this phone is pretty much worth it.

WE SAY

7.5

The iPhone 3GS is a very nice phone with a lot of things going for it and a few shortcomings – we did not like the mediocre performance while on a call, and the fact of the matter is that better displays from other vendors are emerging like the display on the Samsung Galaxy S. It is also overpriced in comparison to other smartphones in the market, and therefore cannot be recommended, especially since the iPhone 4 might be available soon in India.

7.5

The Sony Ericsson X10 mini Pro has a small but well laid out keypad. It is a compact and well rounded device, delivering good all round performance. It features an upgradeable and future proof platform. At ₹16,000 the Sony Ericsson XPERIA X10 Mini Pro is a very nice device and for its price, it overshadows even the XPERIA X10 in terms of appeal, if not sheer presence. It can be obtained at a lower price if you look deep enough.

7.5

With most people migrating to touch-based phones, it's all too easy to overlook QWERTY based workhorses such as these. Nokia knows how to make a great handset, and the E72 is probably the pick of the QWERTY-based E series devices. It offers more features than BlackBerry devices in the same league and what's more important is the affordable price point at which Nokia is offering this phone.

7.5

The new Nokia N8 is a step in the right direction. A great camera that actually offers a lot of manual control, a good, snappy interface, a very nice on-screen QWERTY keypad, and the usual Symbian goodness that makes their devices good phones. The N8 is well built too with a metal body. We'd like a higher resolution screen though, and the price tag is slightly on the higher side. Other than that, the N8 is a very feature rich phone, missing out only, on a hardware keypad.